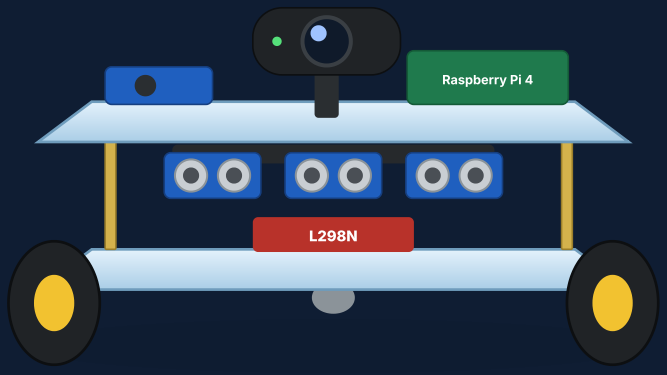
RAQIB · AI INSPECTION ROBOT · BUDGET EDITION

Build the robot

Under RM 500: what to buy, every part pictured and explained, how to wire each sensor, and how to put the robot together, step by step.



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Final-year IoT project · UNISIRAJ

Guide version 2.4 · October 2026
Matches the Raqib software 2.4 · parts ≈ RM 494

Inside this guide

1. **How the robot works** - the parts and how they talk to each other
2. **Shopping list** - every part, how many, why, and an estimated price (under RM 500)
3. **Meet the parts** - a picture of each part and the pins you will use
4. **Safety first** - the battery, voltages and moving wheels
5. **The pin map** - every Raspberry Pi pin the robot uses
6. **Build it in 12 steps** - assembly and wiring, one part at a time, with a test after each
7. **Troubleshooting** - what to do when something does not answer
8. **Final checklist** - before the first demo
9. **Upgrades later** - parts you can add when you have more budget

> **The golden rule:** wire one part, test it, then add the next. When something does not work, you know it is the part you just added. Every step ends with a check box list and a test command.

> **Wire colours used in every diagram**
>
> 5 V · 3.3 V · GND · SDA · SCL · battery + · motor · PWM · signal
>
> Use the same colours for your real jumper wires where you can: it makes mistakes easy to spot.

> **Practise first, for free:** the Wokwi picture guide lets you wire most of these sensors in a browser simulator, and the phone app's *Try the demo robot* button shows what the finished robot does.

1 How the robot works

The Raspberry Pi 4 is the brain. It runs the robot program and also its own small server, so the phone app talks straight to the robot over Wi-Fi: no laptop. One battery pack powers everything: the motors directly, the Pi through a small 5 V converter. A hand-made **hub board** shares power and the I²C bus with the sensors, and each sensor group has one job.

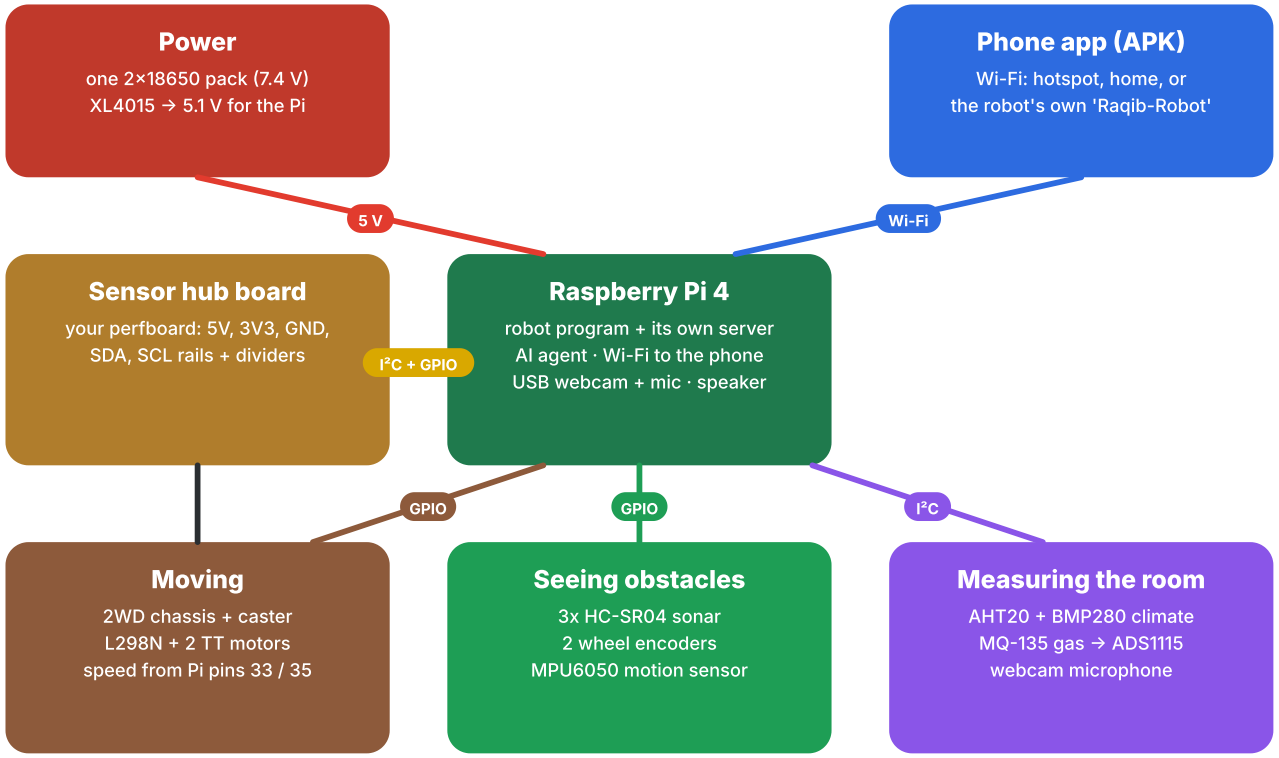


Figure 1 - the five groups of parts around the Raspberry Pi.

Two kinds of connection

I²C bus (2 wires, SDA + SCL): three boards share it, each with its own address - ADS1115 0x48, MPU6050 0x68, AHT20 0x38 + BMP280 0x77.

GPIO pins: one wire per signal - motor direction and speed, sonar trigger/echo and wheel encoders.

Two voltages

5 V for the sonars, gas heater and amplifier.

3.3 V for everything that talks to the Pi. A Pi pin must **never** see 5 V: the voltage dividers on the hub board take care of the 5 V outputs (sonar Echo and MQ-135) and the battery voltage.

> **The camera does not move.** Instead of servos, the robot turns its whole body to look left or right (the app's *Drive → Camera* pad works the same), and turns back before it drives on. This saves about RM 40.

2 Shopping list

Prices are **estimates in Malaysian ringgit** from typical Malaysian online electronics shops (Cytron, Techmakers, Shopee / Lazada sellers) in 2026. Check current prices and stock before you buy; shop around and the total can drop further.

#	Part	Qty	RM each	RM
The brain				
1	**Raspberry Pi 4 Model B, 2 GB** Runs the robot program and its own server. 2 GB is enough: the AI runs in the cloud	1	240	240
2	**microSD card 16 GB, A1 / Class 10** Holds Raspberry Pi OS and the robot software	1	12	12
3	**Aluminium heatsink set for the Pi 4** Keeps the Pi from slowing down when it gets warm	1	4	4
Power (one battery for everything)				
4	**18650 Li-ion cells, flat top, 2500-3000 mAh** Known brands only. Avoid fake '9900 mAh' cells	2	15	30
5	**2 × 18650 battery holder with on/off switch and leads** 7.4 V pack; its switch is the robot's power switch	1	6	6
6	**XL4015 5 A step-down converter (adjustable)** Makes a steady 5.1 V for the Pi from the battery	1	9	9
7	**USB-A to USB-C cable, 3 A (you cut the A end off)** XL4015 output → Pi power input	1	5	5
8	**1000 µF 16 V electrolytic capacitor** Stops motor starts from resetting the Pi	1	1	1
9	**2-slot USB 18650 charger** Charges the two cells	1	12	12
Moving				
10	**2WD smart car chassis kit: acrylic deck, 2 TT motors (3-6 V), 2 wheels, caster, screws** The body. Choose a kit whose motors have a shaft on both sides (for the encoder discs)	1	28	28
11	**L298N dual H-bridge motor driver** Turns the Pi's small signals into motor power	1	9	9
12	**Speed encoder module (LM393 slot sensor) + 20-slot disc** Counts wheel turns: 'go forward 2 m' stops at 2 m	2	4	8
Sensing				
13	**HC-SR04 ultrasonic distance sensor** Left, centre, right: stops before obstacles and steers round them	3	4	12
14	**MPU6050 motion sensor (GY-521 board)** Knows how far the robot has turned	1	8	8
15	**AHT20 + BMP280 combo board** Temperature, humidity and air pressure	1	10	10
16	**MQ-135 gas sensor module** CO2 / gas level	1	8	8
17	**ADS1115 16-bit ADC board** Reads the gas sensor and the battery voltage (the Pi has no analog input)	1	12	12
Camera and sound				

#	Part	Qty	RM each	RM
18	**USB webcam 720p with built-in microphone** Photos, live video and hearing in one part	1	30	30
19	**PAM8403 amplifier board** Makes the voice loud enough	1	4	4
20	**Speaker 3 W 4 Ω, about 40 mm** The robot's voice	1	5	5
21	**3.5 mm male audio cable (you will cut one end)** Pi audio jack → amplifier	1	3	3
Wiring and mounting				
22	**Resistors: 1 kΩ x 3, 2 kΩ x 3, 4.7 kΩ x 1, 10 kΩ x 2, 20 kΩ x 1** Voltage dividers: protect the Pi and measure the battery	1	3	3
23	**Perfboard / stripboard about 7 × 9 cm** Your 'hub board'	1	3	3
24	**Jumper wires: F-F and M-F, 40 of each** Most connections plug in, no soldering	1	10	10
25	**Male + female pin header strips** Plug-in points on the hub board	1	3	3
26	**22 AWG wire, red + black, 1 m each** Motor and battery wiring	1	5	5
27	**M3 standoffs 35-40 mm + M2.5 / M3 screws (nylon kit)** Second deck (spare acrylic, wood or plastic sheet) and board mounting	1	8	8
28	**Zip ties, double-sided foam tape, heat-shrink** Tidy, safe, nothing rattles loose	1	6	6
	Total for the robot (estimate, under RM 500)			**≈ 494**

Tools (borrow them from the lab: not counted in the RM 494)

Tool	RM
Soldering iron with solder and stand Motor leads, hub board, header pins	50
Digital multimeter Set the XL4015 to 5.1 V and check every voltage BEFORE connecting the Pi	40
Small screwdriver set (Phillips + flat) Screw terminals and chassis	15
Wire stripper / side cutter Clean wire ends	15
Hot glue gun Fix cables and the encoder sensors	20

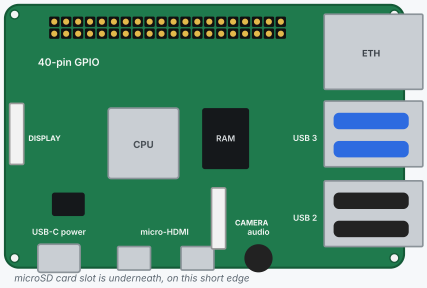
Buying tips

- **Save more:** a used Raspberry Pi 4 (2 GB or 4 GB) often sells for RM 150-200. Ask your department too: many labs lend Pis to final-year students.
- **18650 cells:** buy known brands from a trusted seller. Real cells are 2500-3500 mAh; anything claiming "9900 mAh" is fake and unsafe. Flat-top cells fit most holders.
- Check the **chassis kit** photo: TT motors with a shaft on **both** sides, encoder discs included is a bonus.
- **Webcam:** any small UVC "plug and play" USB webcam with a built-in microphone works; the robot finds it by itself.
- No 2 kΩ resistors? Two 1 kΩ in series make 2 kΩ.
- Have a phone charger with a USB-C cable? Use it to power the Pi on your desk while you install the software.

Budget: about **RM 494** for the robot. Nothing in the app is lost: the same software runs this build and the bigger one, and finds by itself which parts you fitted. See *Upgrades later* at the end.

3 Meet the parts

What each part looks like, what it does, which pins you will use and one tip. The pictures are drawings of the common versions; your boards may differ slightly in colour or pin order, so always read the labels printed on the board.

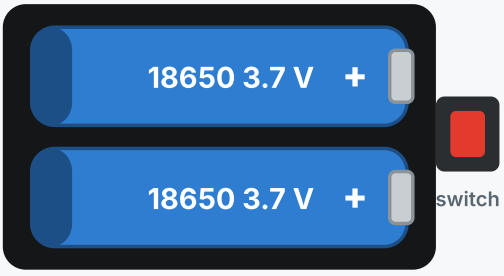


Raspberry Pi 4

The robot's computer: drives, senses, runs its own server for the phone.

Connections: 40-pin GPIO header (top edge) · USB-C power · USB ports for the webcam · 3.5 mm audio jack for the speaker

💡 2 GB is enough. Put the microSD card in the slot underneath on the short edge.



Battery: 2 × 18650

The only battery: motors straight from it, the Pi through the XL4015.

Connections: Red + → L298N +12V and XL4015 IN+ · black – → L298N GND and XL4015 IN−

💡 7.4 V nominal, 8.4 V full, about 6.6 V empty. Its switch turns the whole robot on and off.

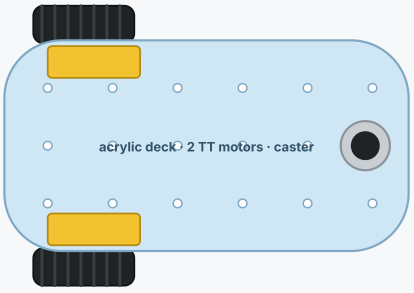


XL4015 step-down converter

Turns the battery's 7-8 V into a steady 5.1 V for the Pi.

Connections: IN+ / IN− from the battery (1000 µF across them) · OUT+ / OUT− → the cut USB cable → Pi

💡 Turn the brass screw until OUT reads 5.1 V, BEFORE the Pi is plugged in.

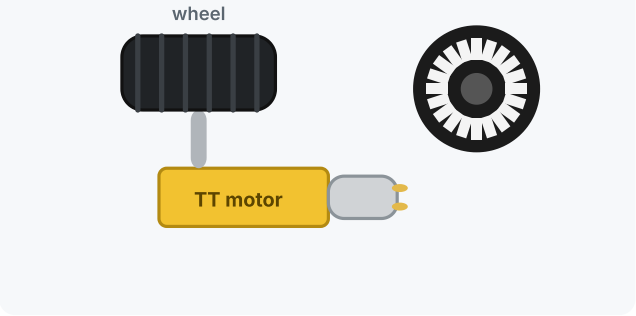


2WD chassis kit

Acrylic deck, two TT gear motors, two wheels and a caster.

Connections: Motors under the deck at the front · caster at the back · second deck on standoffs

💡 Check the motors have a shaft on both sides for the encoder discs.

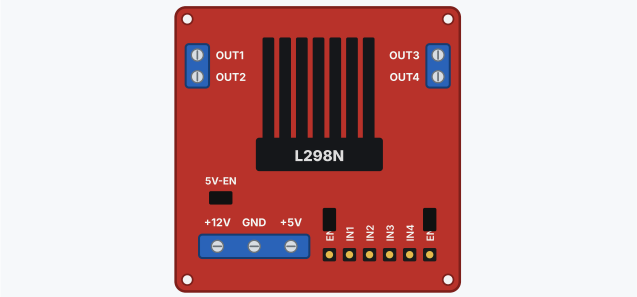


TT gear motor + encoder disc

3-6 V geared motor; the 20-slot disc tells how far it turned.

Connections: 2 solder tabs per motor (red / black wires)

💡 Solder wires before you mount the motors; it is hard afterwards.

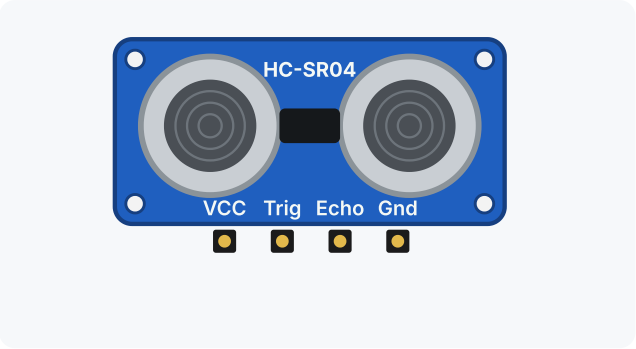


L298N motor driver

Switches battery power to the motors forwards or backwards.

Connections: +12V / GND from the battery · OUT1-OUT4 to motors · IN1-IN4 and ENA/ENB from the Pi

💡 Remove the ENA and ENB jumpers. Keep the 5V-EN jumper.

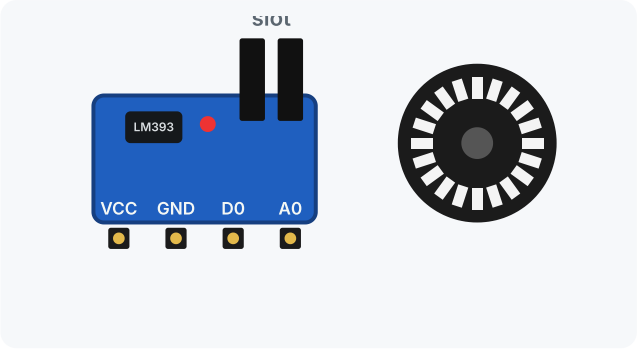


HC-SR04 ultrasonic

Measures distance with sound, 2 cm to 4 m.

Connections: VCC 5V · Trig (from Pi) · Echo (5 V out! needs a divider) · Gnd

💡 Buy 3 + a spare if you can; they sometimes arrive dead.

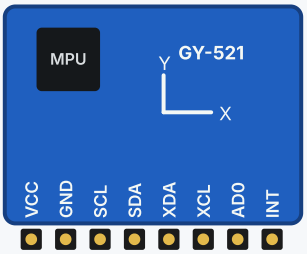


Speed encoder (slot sensor)

Gives one pulse each time a slot of the disc passes.

Connections: VCC 3.3V · GND · D0 (digital, to the Pi) · A0 (not used)

💡 The disc must spin inside the slot without touching it.

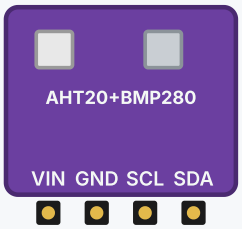


MPU6050 (GY-521)

Gyroscope + accelerometer: the robot's sense of turning.

Connections: VCC · GND · SCL · SDA (the others are not used)

💡 Mount it flat, near the middle of the chassis, with foam tape.



AHT20 + BMP280

Temperature and humidity (AHT20) plus air pressure (BMP280) on one board.

Connections: VIN · GND · SCL · SDA

💡 Keep it away from the Pi and the MQ-135: they are warm.

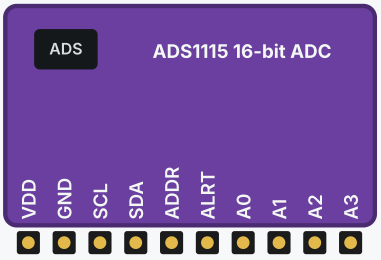


MQ-135 gas sensor

Heated sensor whose voltage rises with CO2 and gases.

Connections: VCC 5V · GND · AO (analog, via divider) · DO (not used)

💡 Burn it in for 24-48 h the first time. It gets hot: no plastic touching it.



ADS1115 ADC

Turns the gas sensor and battery voltages into numbers for the Pi.

Connections: VDD 3.3V · GND · SCL · SDA · ADDR → GND · A0 = gas · A1 = battery

💡 Powered from 3.3 V so it is safe on the Pi's I²C bus.

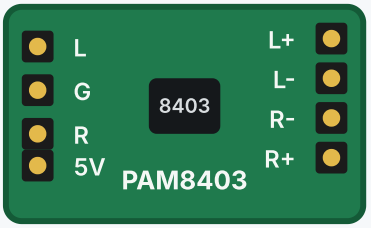


USB webcam with microphone

The robot's eyes and ears: photos, live video and sound.

Connections: Any USB port (a blue USB 3 port is best)

💡 Choose one sold as 'plug and play / UVC' with a built-in microphone.



PAM8403 amplifier

Small 3 W amplifier for the speaker.

Connections: 5V/GND power · L G R input from the Pi's audio jack · L+ L− output

💡 Use only the left channel (L+ / L−).



3 W 4 Ω speaker

Speaker 3 W 4 Ω

The robot's voice.

Connections: 2 wires to L+ and L−

💡 Face it outwards at the back of the top deck.

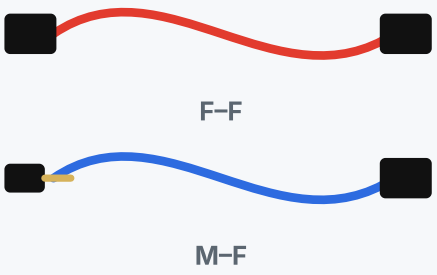


Resistors

Voltage dividers: protect the Pi and measure the battery.

Connections: No polarity: either way round

💡 No 2 kΩ? Two 1 kΩ in series. No 4.7 kΩ? Use 5.1 kΩ and set battery_divider_gain: 2.96.

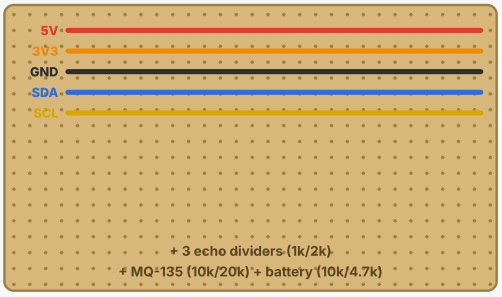


Jumper wires

Plug-in connections.

Connections: F = socket (fits on a pin) · M = pin

💡 Use colours: red 5 V, orange 3.3 V, black GND.

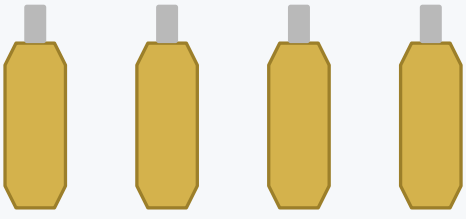


Hub board (you make it)

One place where power, the I²C bus and all dividers meet.

Connections: 5V · 3V3 · GND · SDA · SCL rails + 5 dividers

💡 Step 5 shows how to build it.



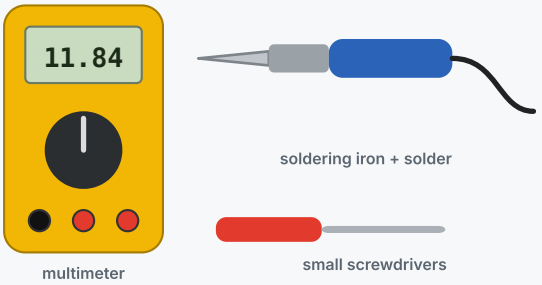
M3 standoffs 35-40 mm + screws

Standoffs and screws

Hold the second deck and the boards.

Connections: M3 for the deck, M2.5 for the Pi

💡 Nylon washers stop shorts under boards.



Tools

What you need on the desk (borrow them from the lab).

Connections: Soldering iron, multimeter, screwdrivers, stripper, hot glue

💡 Measure, then connect. Always.

4 Safety first

Lithium batteries store a lot of energy.

- Never short the + and − of a cell or pack (no loose wires, no metal tools across terminals).
- Check polarity three times before inserting a cell: + goes to the + mark.
- Charge only with a proper Li-ion charger, never unattended, on a non-flammable surface.
- Do not use cells with dents, torn wrapping or that get hot; recycle them.
- Switch the battery off before changing any wire.

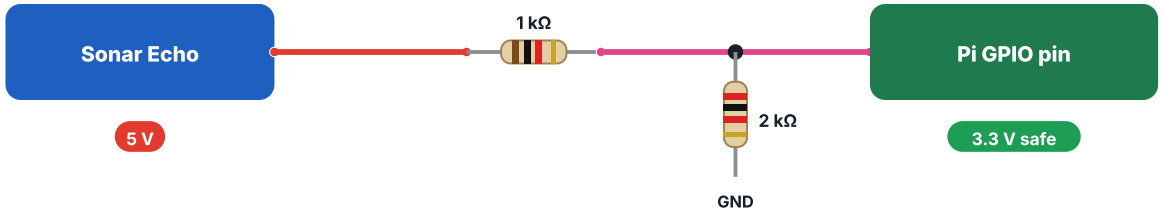
Protect the Raspberry Pi.

- Its GPIO pins are **3.3 V only**. 5 V on a GPIO pin damages it instantly, so every 5 V output goes through a divider.
- Set the XL4015 to **5.1 V** with the multimeter **before** the Pi is plugged in: straight from the box it may give 12 V or more.
- Never power motors from the Pi's pins.
- Measure each power rail with the multimeter before plugging a board in.
- Touch something metal before handling boards (static electricity).

Moving parts.

- Test motors with the robot on a box, **wheels in the air**.
- Keep fingers and hair away from the wheels.
- The MQ-135 heater, the XL4015 and the L298N heatsink get hot.

The two rules you will use most



A voltage divider: 5 V × 2 kΩ / (1 kΩ + 2 kΩ) = 3.33 V, safe for the Pi.

And: **measure, then connect**. Put the multimeter on DC volts, black probe on GND, red probe on the rail. 5 V rail: 4.9-5.2 V. 3.3 V rail: 3.2-3.4 V. Battery: 6.6-8.4 V. XL4015 output: 5.0-5.2 V.

5 The pin map

Every Raspberry Pi pin the robot uses. Physical pin numbers (1-40) are what you count on the header; the GPIO names are what the software uses (they are already set in `edge/config.yaml`).



Figure 2 - Raspberry Pi 4 header, top view, USB ports pointing down the page.

> Everything else does not touch the header: the webcam (camera + microphone) uses USB, the speaker amplifier uses the 3.5 mm audio jack, and the gas sensor and battery voltage go through the ADS1115.

6 Build it in 12 steps

Each step lists what you need, what to do, a picture, and a check. Do them in order.

1 Prepare the Raspberry Pi (software first)

You need: Pi 4, microSD card, a USB-C phone charger, your PC

1. On the PC install **Raspberry Pi Imager**. Choose *Raspberry Pi 4 → Raspberry Pi OS (64-bit)* (the Lite version is fine) → your microSD card.
2. In the settings (gear / "Edit settings"): hostname `robot01`, a username and password, **enable SSH**, and add a Wi-Fi. Your **phone's hotspot** is the best one: the robot then has internet for the AI wherever you go.
3. Write the card, put it in the Pi (slot underneath), power the Pi from a USB-C phone charger. Wait 2 minutes.
4. On the PC, double-click `pack_robot_for_pi.bat` in the project folder. It makes `raqib-robot.zip`.
5. Copy the zip to the Pi (WinSCP to `robot01.local`, or a USB stick) and run on the Pi:

```
unzip raqib-robot.zip -d ~/raqib
cd ~/raqib && bash edge/scripts/install_pi.sh
sudo reboot
```

The installer sets real-hardware mode, starts the robot and its server at every power-on, and makes the robot's own Wi-Fi **Raqib-Robot** (password `raqib1234`) when no known Wi-Fi is around.

Check before you continue

☐ The Pi boots and you can log in (SSH or keyboard + screen)

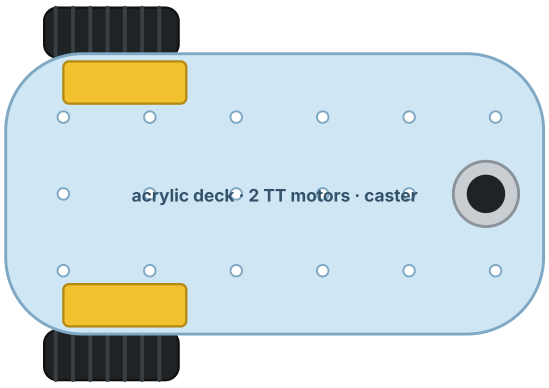
☐ The installer ended with 'Done'

☐ The phone app finds the robot ('Find automatically'); Robot health shows every part red: correct, nothing is wired yet

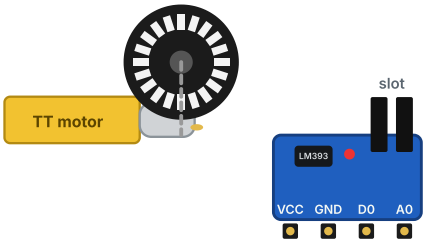
2 Chassis, motors and wheel encoders

You need: chassis kit, 2 TT motors, wheels, caster, 2 encoder discs + modules, wire, soldering iron

1. **Solder** a red and a black 20 cm wire to the two tabs of each motor. Twist each pair.
2. Fix the 2 motors under the deck with the kit's brackets and long screws, wires towards the middle. Screw the caster on at the back.
3. Push an **encoder disc** onto the inner shaft of each motor.
4. Mount each encoder module so its disc spins inside the slot without touching (small bracket, standoff or hot glue).
5. Push the wheels onto the outer shafts.



1. Screw the 2 motors under the bottom deck; caster at the back



2. Disc on the motor's inner shaft, spinning inside the slot of the encoder module

Motors under the deck; the encoder disc spins in the sensor's slot.

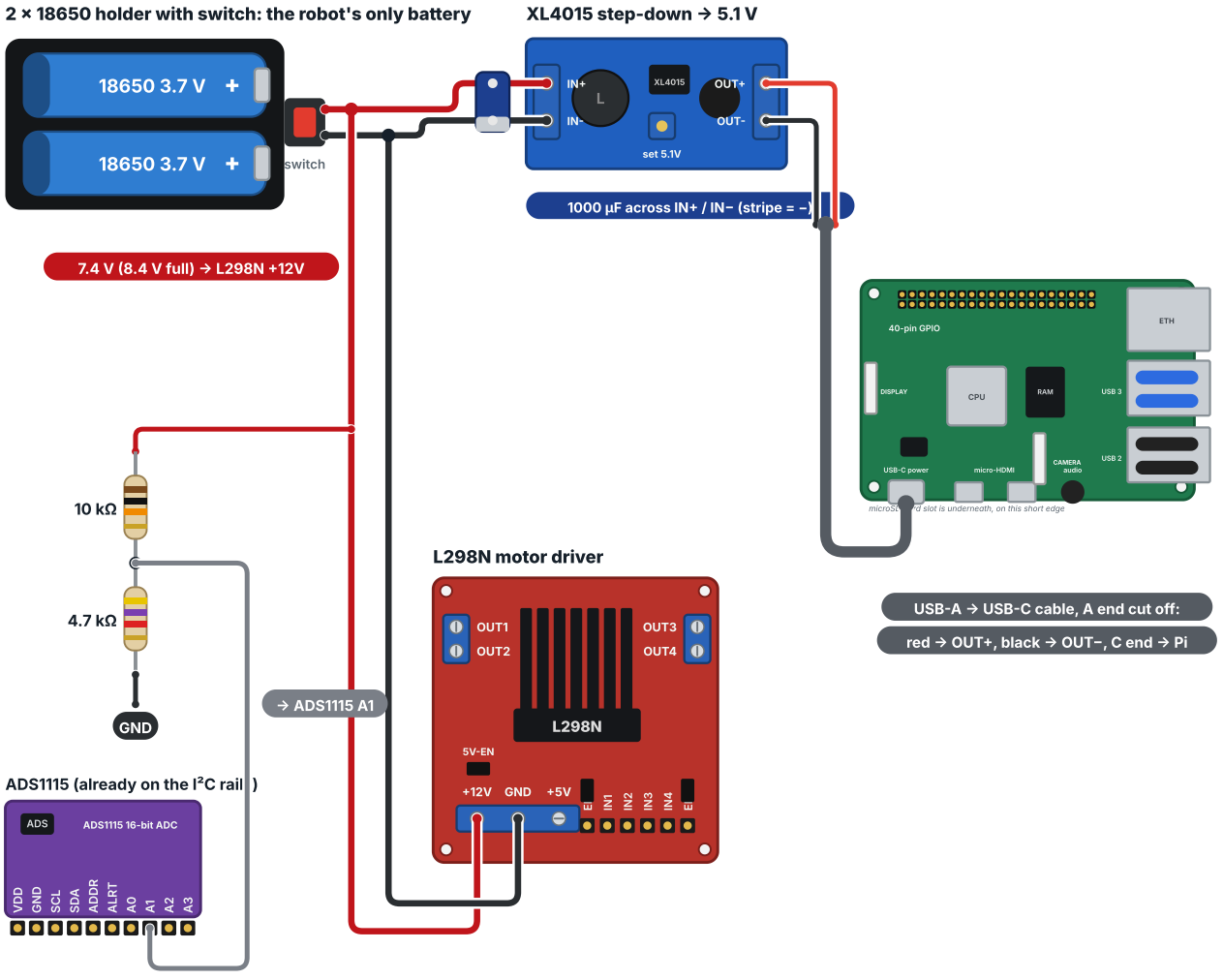
Check before you continue

- ☐ Both wheels turn freely by hand and the caster swivels
- ☐ Each encoder disc passes through its slot without rubbing
- ☐ Each motor has one red + one black wire to go to the L298N

3 Power: one battery, the 5 V converter and the motor driver

You need: battery holder + 2 cells, XL4015, 1000 µF capacitor, USB-A to USB-C cable, L298N, wire, multimeter

1. Cut the USB-A plug off the cable, about 15 cm from the plug. Strip the outer jacket: keep the **red** (+5 V) and **black** (GND) wires, cut the thin green and white wires short and tape them.
2. Battery holder **red** → XL4015 **IN+** and L298N **+12V**; **black** → XL4015 **IN−** and L298N **GND** (two wires under one screw is fine, or twist and solder a short splice).
3. Put the 1000 µF capacitor across XL4015 IN+ / IN−: the long leg to IN+, the striped side to IN−.
4. Insert the cells (**check polarity**), switch on. Measure XL4015 OUT+ to OUT− and turn its brass screw until it reads **5.1 V**. (It may start at 12 V or more.) Switch off.
5. Cable red → XL4015 OUT+, black → OUT−. Fix the XL4015 and L298N on the bottom deck, the battery holder underneath.
6. Plug the USB-C end into the Pi and switch on: the Pi boots from the battery.



One pack feeds everything: the L298N takes the battery straight, the XL4015 makes 5.1 V for the Pi. The 1000 µF capacitor stops motor starts from dipping the Pi's supply. All grounds are joined through the battery − wire.

Set the XL4015 to 5.1 V with the multimeter BEFORE the Pi is plugged in. The divider lets the app show the battery %.

Figure 3 - power wiring, and the battery divider used in step 10.

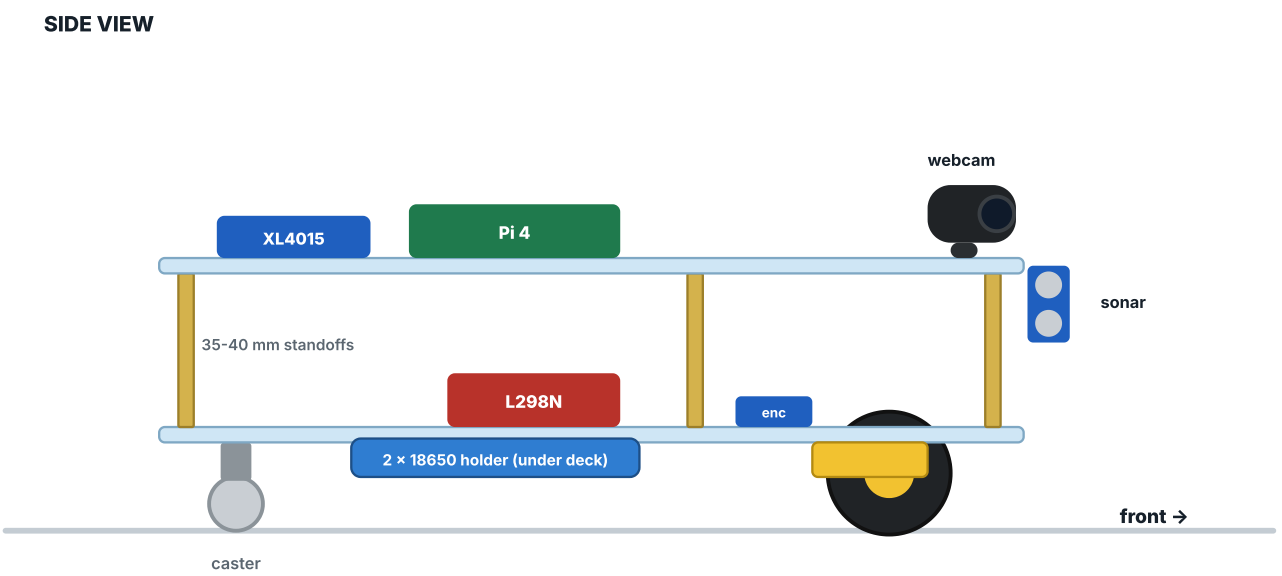
Check before you continue

- ☐ Battery reads 7-8.4 V at the L298N +12V terminal
- ☐ XL4015 OUT reads 5.0-5.2 V
- ☐ The Pi boots from the battery alone
- ☐ Charging: take the 2 cells out and put them in the USB charger

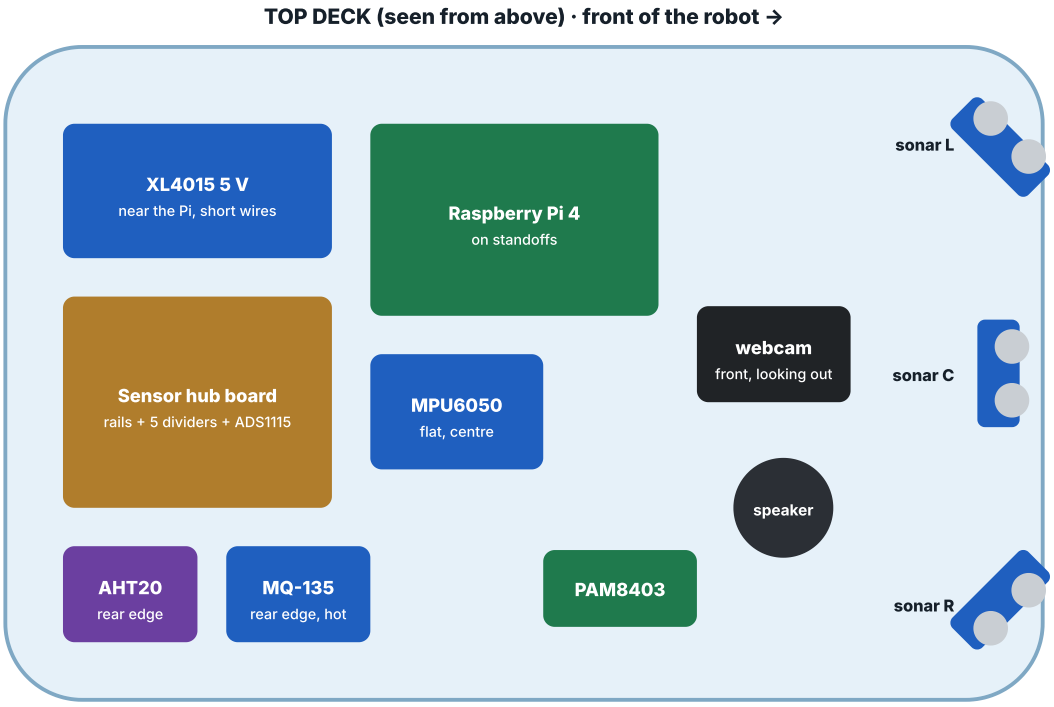
4 Mount the boards

You need: standoffs, screws, foam tape, a second deck (spare acrylic, plywood or plastic)

Follow the layout: the battery low and central, warm parts (Pi, XL4015, MQ-135) away from the AHT20, sonars on the front edge, the webcam at the front looking forward.



Side view: two decks on 35-40 mm standoffs.



Bottom deck: battery holder, L298N, the 2 motors and encoders. Keep AHT20 and MQ-135 away from the Pi CPU.

Top deck layout.

Check before you continue

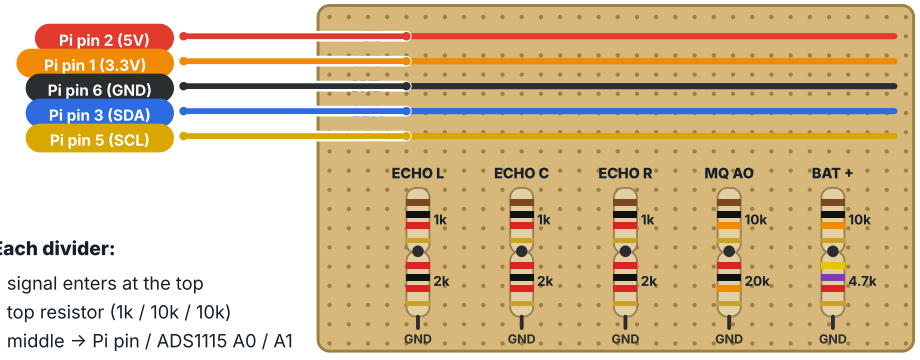
- ☐ Nothing touches the wheels
- ☐ No board's underside touches metal (use nylon washers)
- ☐ The top deck can still come off to reach the L298N and the battery

5 Build the hub board

You need: perfboard, resistors (3 × 1k, 3 × 2k, 2 × 10k, 1 × 20k, 1 × 4.7k), header strips, wire, soldering iron

The hub board is the heart of the wiring: five rails that every sensor plugs into, and the five voltage dividers.

1. Solder five long rails (bare wire or the board's strips): **5V, 3V3, GND, SDA, SCL**. Label them with a marker.
2. Solder a female header strip along each rail so jumper wires can plug in.
3. Solder the three sonar dividers (1 kΩ on top, 2 kΩ to GND), the MQ-135 divider (10 kΩ on top, 20 kΩ to GND) and the battery divider (10 kΩ on top, 4.7 kΩ to GND). Put a header pin on the input and on the middle point of each.
4. Connect the rails to the Pi with F-F jumpers: pin 2 → 5V, pin 1 → 3V3, pin 6 → GND, pin 3 → SDA, pin 5 → SCL.



Each divider:

- signal enters at the top
- top resistor (1k / 10k / 10k)
- middle → Pi pin / ADS1115 A0 / A1
- bottom (2k / 20k / 4.7k) → GND
- 5 V → 3.3 V · battery 8.4 V → 2.7 V

Solder the rails as bare wire along the strips; every module plugs into the rails with jumper wires.

Figure 4 - the hub board: rails on top, dividers below.

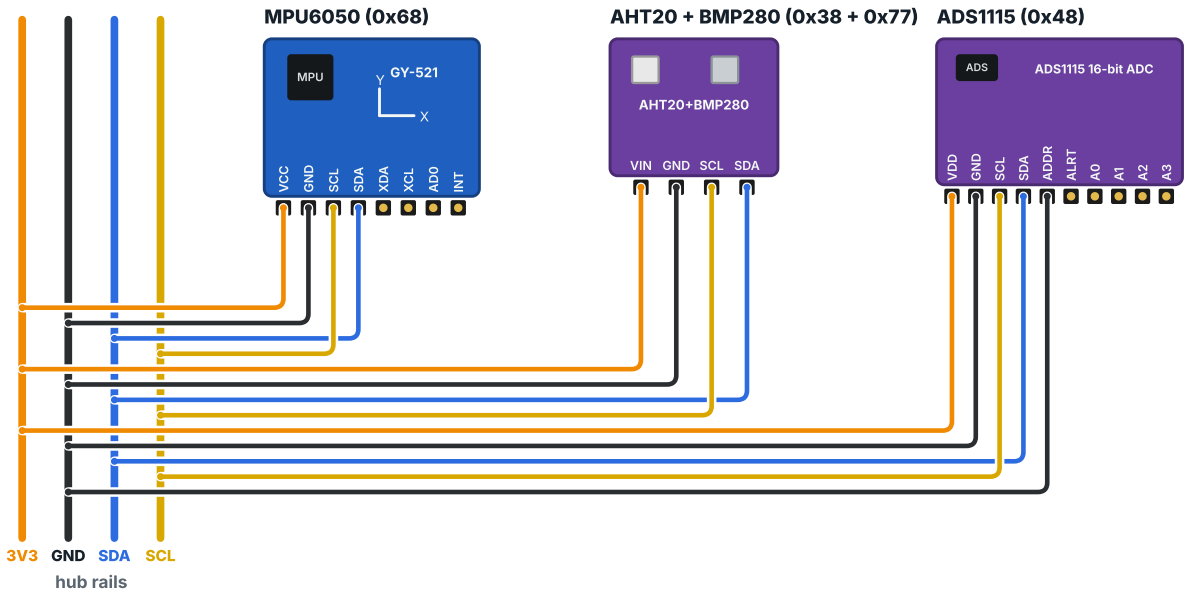
Check before you continue

- ☐ Multimeter, Pi on, nothing else plugged in: 5V rail ≈ 5 V, 3V3 rail ≈ 3.3 V
- ☐ No two rails are shorted (continuity mode: no beep between rails)
- ☐ Each sonar/MQ divider: 5 V on its input reads ≈ 3.3 V at its middle point
- ☐ Battery divider: 8 V on its input reads ≈ 2.6 V at its middle point

6 I²C boards: MPU6050, AHT20 + BMP280, ADS1115

You need: the three boards, F-F jumpers

Every I²C board gets four wires from the hub rails: **3V3, GND, SDA, SCL**. ADS1115 ADDR → GND as well.



- Every I²C board joins the same four rails: 3.3 V, GND, SDA, SCL.
- Each answers to its own address, so they share two wires without clashing.
- ADS1115 ADDR → GND sets 0x48. A0 = gas sensor, A1 = battery voltage.
- The AHT20 + BMP280 combo board shows as two addresses: 0x38 and 0x77 (or 0x76).
- Test: python -m hwtest.i2c_scan lists every address found.

Figure 5 - the I²C bus.

```
sudo systemctl stop inspection-robot     # stop the robot program while you test
cd ~/raqib/edge && source .venv/bin/activate
python -m hwtest.i2c_scan
```

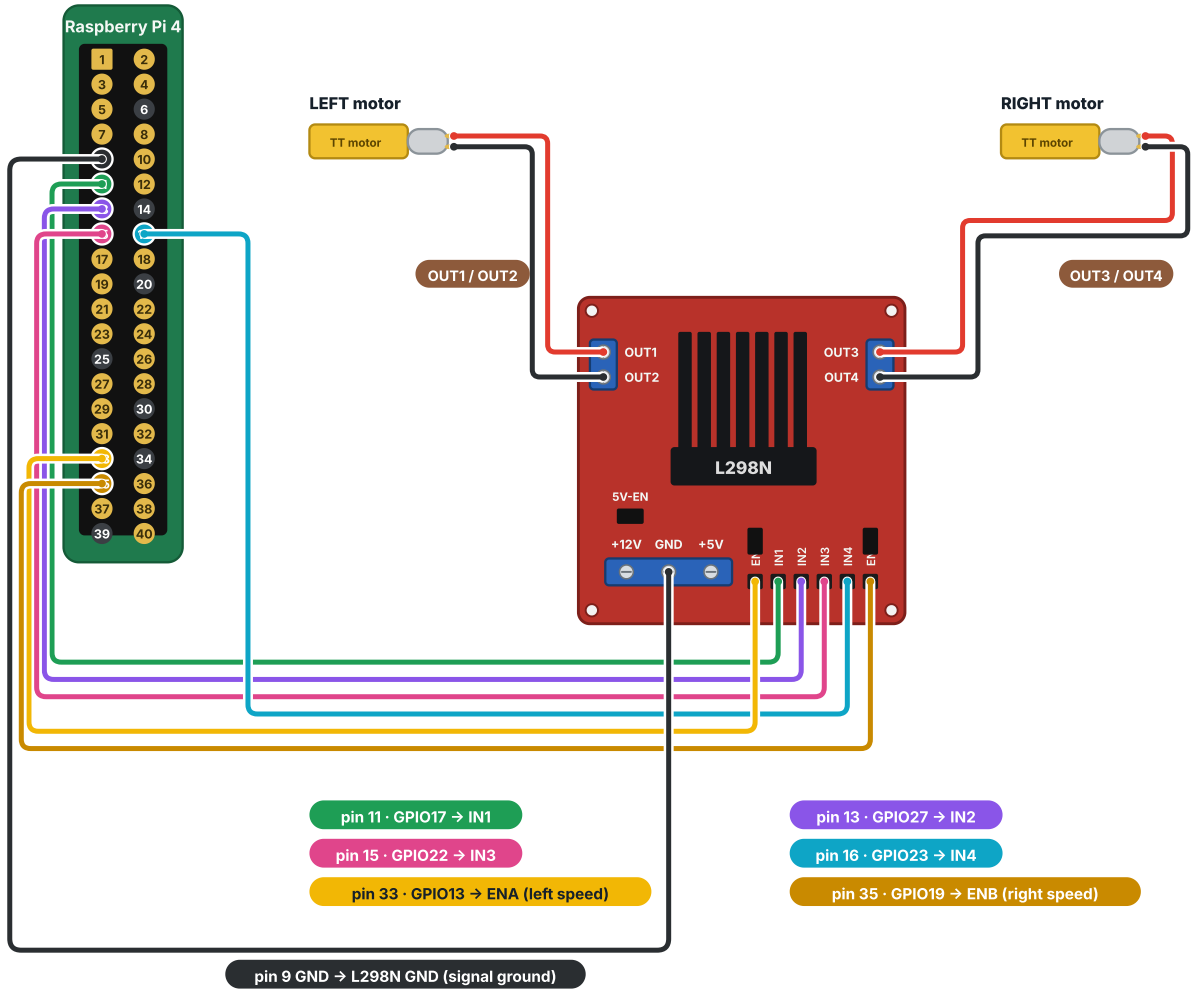
Check before you continue

- ☐ i2c_scan shows 0x38 + 0x77 or 0x76 (AHT20 + BMP280), 0x48 (ADS1115) and 0x68 (MPU6050)
- ☐ It says motor speed will come from GPIO 13/19 (no PCA9685 found): correct for this build

7 Motors: the L298N and the Pi

You need: L298N (already powered), M-F / F-F jumpers

1. Pull the **ENA** and **ENB** jumpers off the L298N. Leave the 5V-EN jumper.
2. Pi pins 11, 13, 15, 16 → L298N IN1, IN2, IN3, IN4 (direction).
3. Pi pin 33 → ENA, pin 35 → ENB (speed).
4. Left motor → OUT1/OUT2, right motor → OUT3/OUT4.
5. L298N GND → Pi pin 9 (a short signal ground).



- Pull the ENA and ENB jumpers off: the Pi sets the speed on pins 33 and 35. Keep the 5V-EN jumper.
- +12V and GND come from the battery (power page). Leave the L298N's +5V terminal unconnected.
- IN pins set the direction, ENA/ENB the speed. A wheel that runs backwards: swap its two motor wires.

Figure 6 - motor wiring.

```
python -m hwtest.test_motors          # robot on a box, wheels in the air!
```

Check before you continue

☐ Each side turns forwards when told 'forward'. Wrong way: swap that motor's OUT wires (or invert: true in config)

☐ Encoder ticks rise for both wheels (shown by the test)

☐ The Pi does not restart when both wheels start

☐ Floor test: python -m hwtest.test_motors --straight 5 drifts less than 20 cm

8 Three distance sensors

You need: 3 HC-SR04, F-F jumpers, hot glue or brackets

1. Mount the sensors on the front edge: left one turned 45° left, centre straight, right one 45° right.
2. VCC → hub 5V, Gnd → hub GND.
3. Trig → Pi pin directly (3.3 V is enough to trigger).
4. Echo → its divider's input on the hub board; the divider's middle point → the Pi pin.

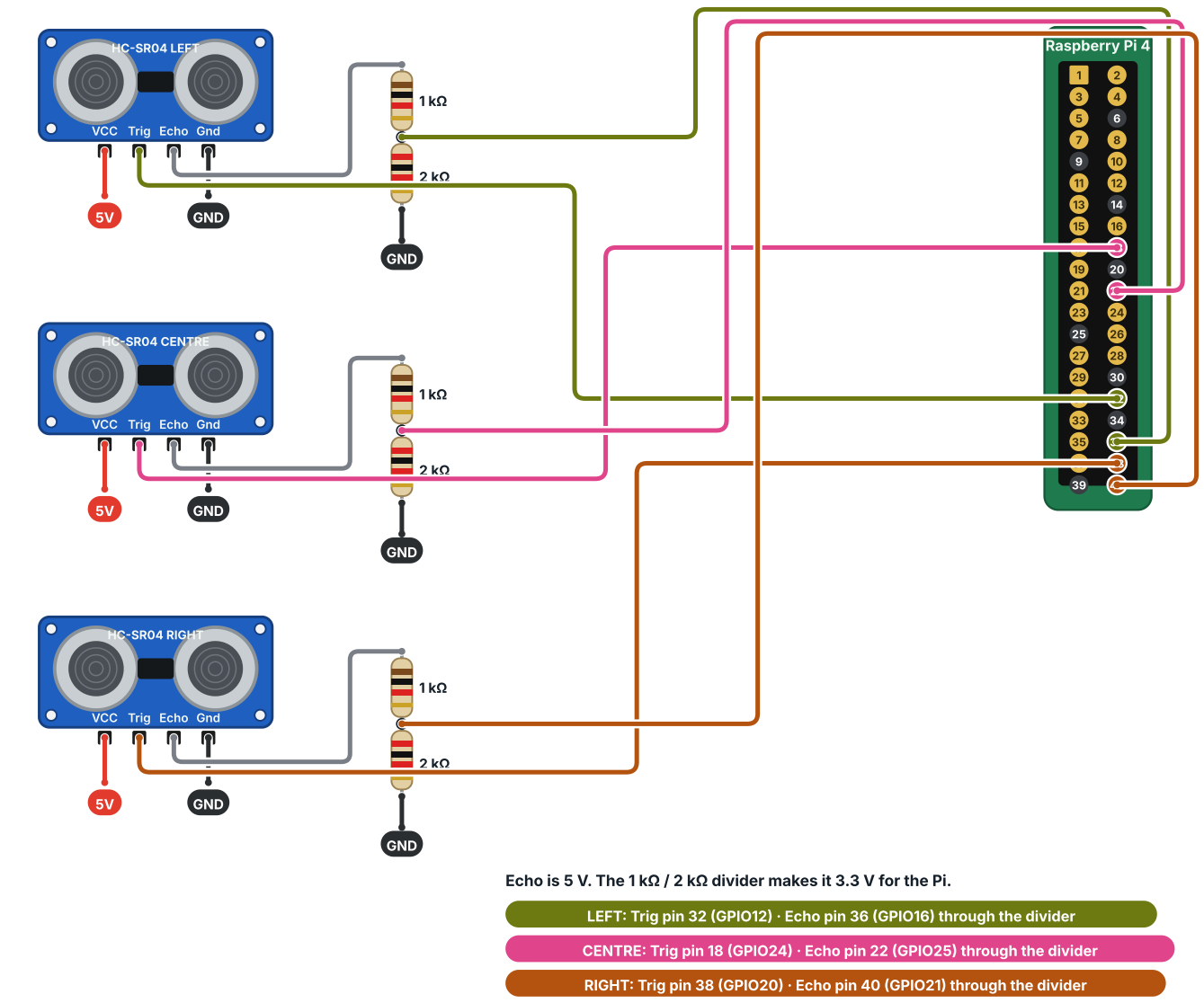


Figure 7 - ultrasonic sensors and their dividers.

```
python -m hwtest.test_sensors
```

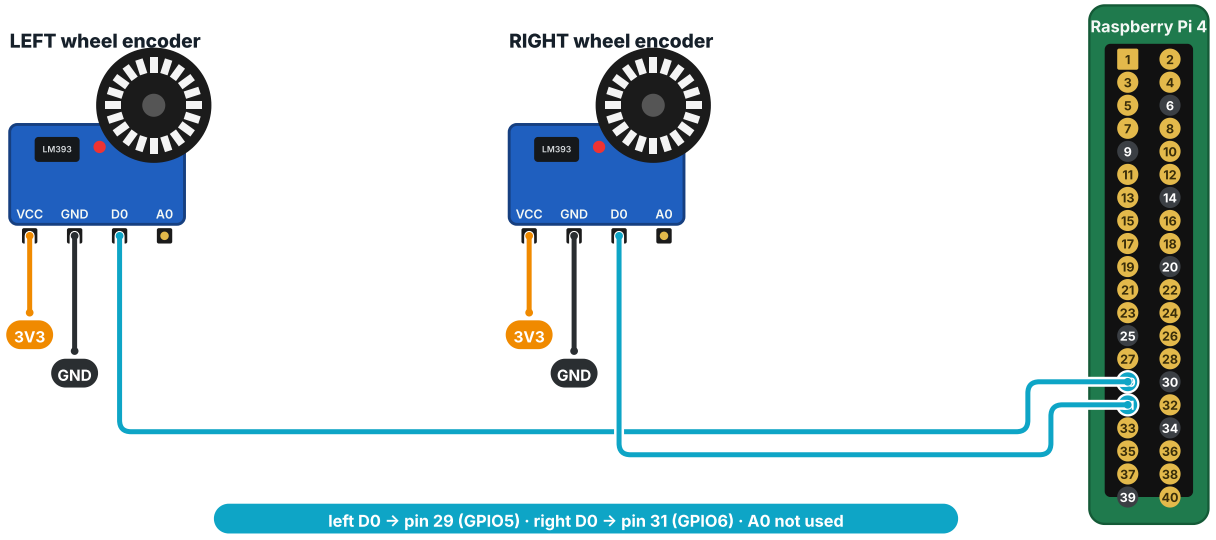
Check before you continue

- ☐ Each distance follows your hand (left, centre, right)
- ☐ A constant 400 cm or 0 means Trig/Echo swapped or a divider fault

9 Wheel encoders

You need: the two encoder modules from step 2, F-F jumpers

1. VCC → hub **3V3** (not 5 V), GND → hub GND.
2. Left D0 → Pi pin 29, right D0 → Pi pin 31.



Power the encoders from 3.3 V so their output is safe for the Pi. The disc must spin freely in the slot.

Figure 8 - encoders.

Check before you continue

- ☐ test_sensors: the 'enc' numbers rise when you turn each wheel by hand
- ☐ The module's LED blinks as slots pass

10 Gas sensor and battery level

You need: MQ-135, ADS1115 (wired in step 6), the hub's MQ and battery dividers

1. MQ-135 VCC → hub 5V, GND → hub GND.
2. MQ-135 AO → the 10 kΩ/20 kΩ divider input; divider middle → ADS1115 **A0**.
3. Battery + (the holder's red wire, at the L298N +12V screw) → the 10 kΩ/4.7 kΩ divider input; divider middle → ADS1115 **A1** (Figure 3).
4. Mount the MQ-135 and AHT20 at the back edge, away from the Pi.

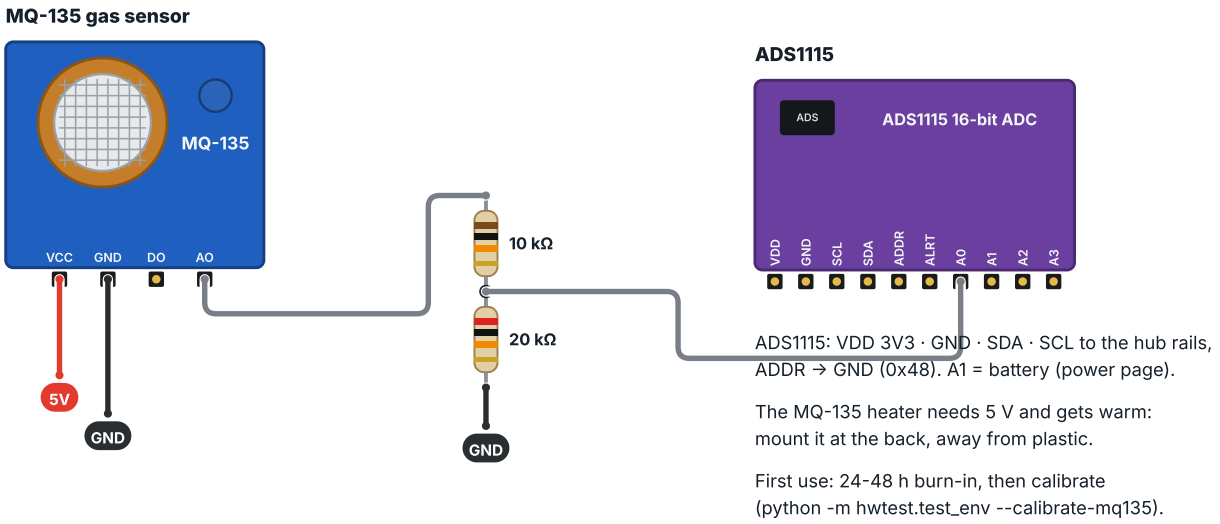


Figure 9 - MQ-135 through the divider into the ADS1115.

```
python -m hwtest.test_env                    # live readings
python -m hwtest.test_env --calibrate-mq135  # outdoors, after 24 h warm-up
```

Check before you continue

- ☐ Temperature and humidity are close to a room thermometer
- ☐ Gas value settles after a few minutes of warm-up
- ☐ Robot health shows the battery: a full pack (8.4 V) is 100 %

11 Webcam, microphone and speaker

You need: USB webcam, PAM8403, speaker, 3.5 mm cable

1. Webcam into a USB port; clip or glue it to the front of the top deck, level and looking forward.
2. Cut the 3.5 mm cable: the tip wire → PAM8403 L, the shield → G. Plug the other end into the Pi's audio jack. PAM8403 5V/GND from the hub.
3. Speaker → PAM8403 L+ and L−.

The robot finds the webcam, its microphone and the audio jack by itself.

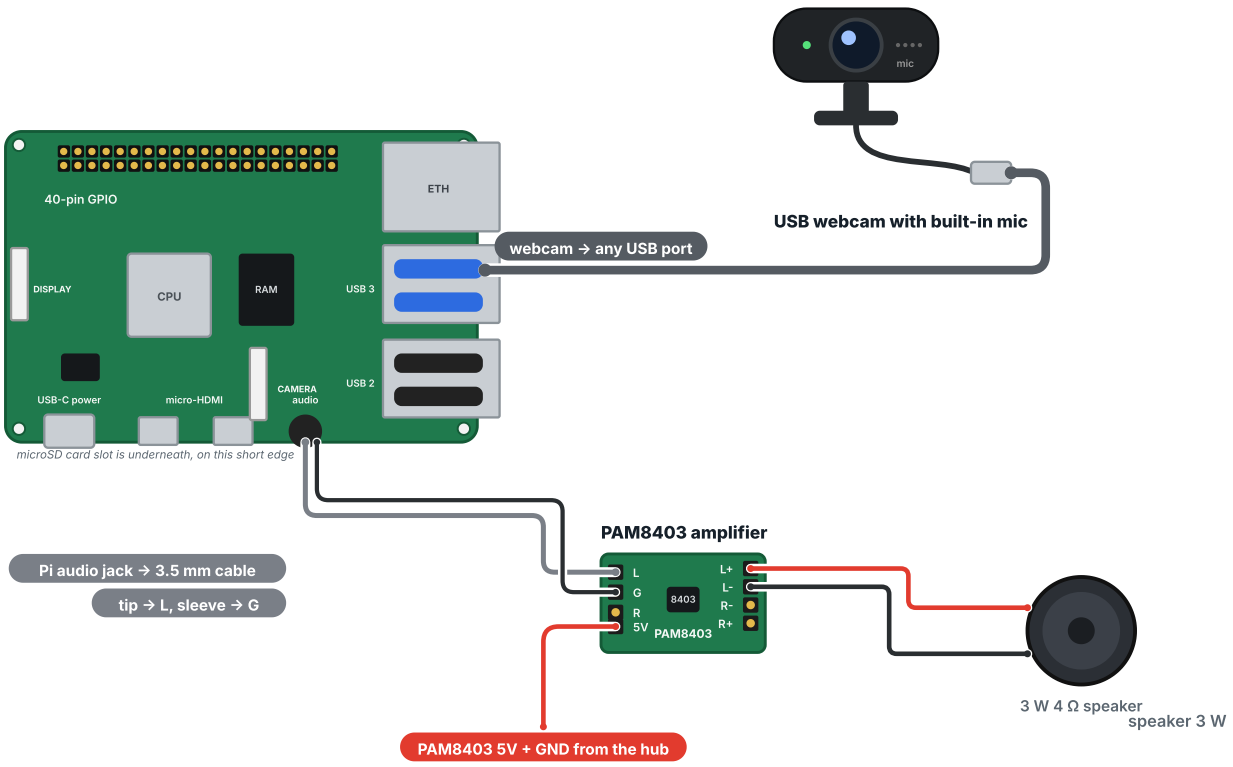


Figure 10 - webcam, audio jack, amplifier and speaker.

```
python -m hwtest.test_camera_audio
speaker-test -D plughw:CARD=Headphones -c1 -t wav -l1   # quick speaker check
```

Check before you continue

- ☐ test_snapshot.jpg shows the room the right way up
- ☐ test_audio.wav has your voice
- ☐ The speaker says the test sentence

12 Everything together

You need: the finished robot, the phone with the Raqib app

1. Tidy the cables with zip ties; nothing near the wheels.
2. Start the robot program again: `sudo systemctl start inspection-robot` (or reboot).
3. Phone on the same Wi-Fi (or join **Raqib-Robot**). Open the app → **Find automatically** → sign in.
4. **More → AI settings**: paste your Gemini key once.
5. **More → Robot health**: every part should be green; *Camera mount* says *fixed camera*, which is correct. Red? Tap it for the fix, then **Re-check parts**.
6. Drive to each room, read the position on the Home screen, and write them under `zones:` in `edge/config.yaml`.

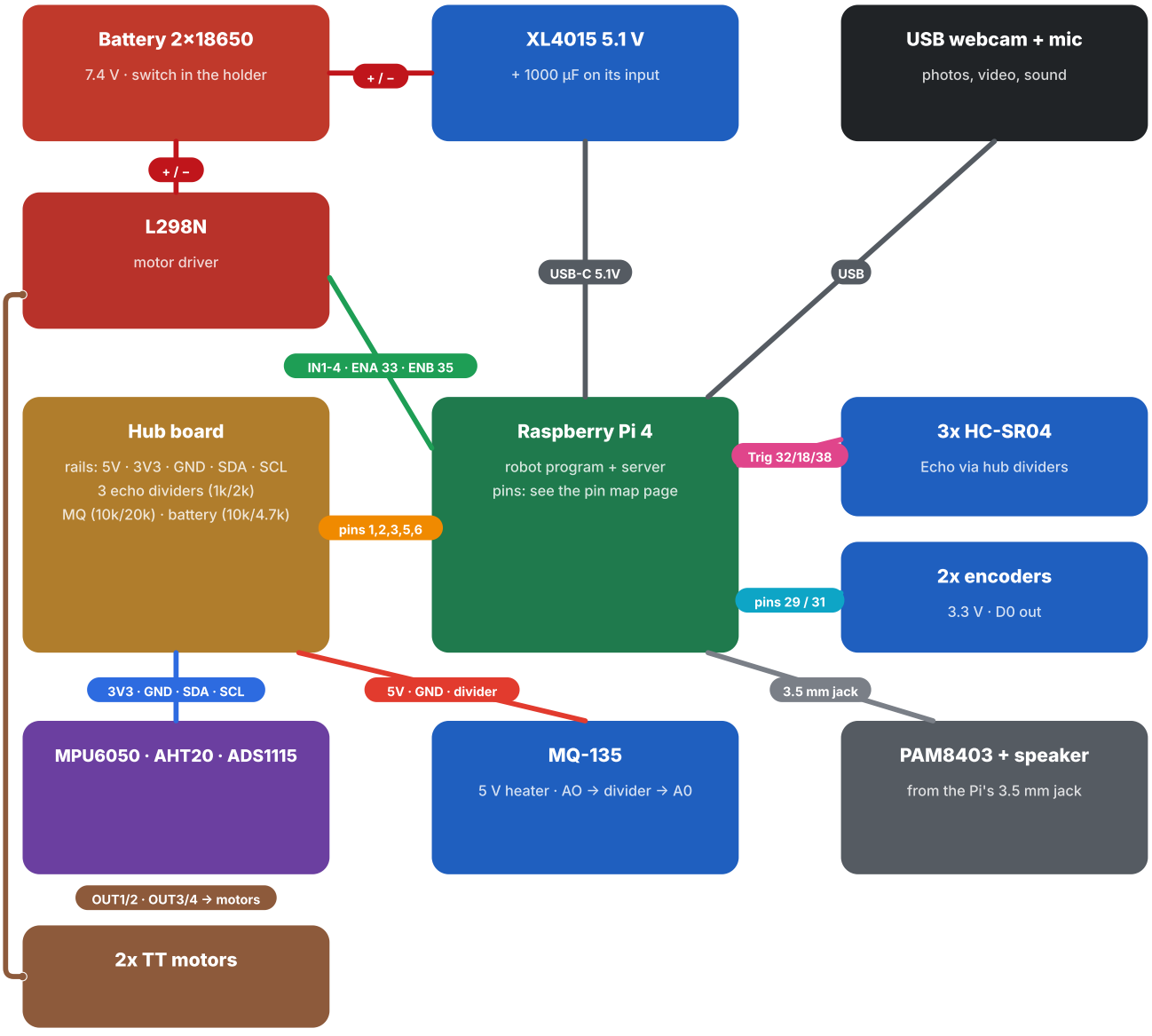


Figure 11 - the complete harness on one page.

Check before you continue

- ☐ Every part green in Robot health
- ☐ STOP in the app stops the robot immediately
- ☐ A hand 30 cm in front of the moving robot stops it before 15 cm
- ☐ Drive → Camera: left turns the whole robot left, centre turns it back

7 Troubleshooting

What you see	Usual cause	Fix
i2c_scan finds nothing	I²C off, SDA/SCL swapped, or no 3.3 V on the rail	sudo raspi-config → Interface → I2C on; check pins 3/5; measure the 3V3 rail
One I²C board is missing	Loose jumper	Re-seat its 4 wires; run i2c_scan again
Wheels do not turn	ENA/ENB jumpers still on, ENA/ENB not on pins 33/35, battery off	Remove the jumpers, check pins 33/35, switch on
One side turns backwards	Motor wires reversed	Swap that motor's two OUT wires, or set invert: true
Pi restarts when the motors start	Weak cells, no capacitor, XL4015 set too low	Charge the cells; 1000 µF on the XL4015 input; set 5.1-5.2 V
Lightning-bolt / 'low voltage' warning	XL4015 below 5 V or thin wires	Set 5.1-5.2 V; keep the USB cable short
Sonar always 400 cm (or 0)	Trig/Echo swapped, no 5 V, wrong divider	Check the pin numbers and measure 5 V at the sensor
Encoder count stays 0	Disc not in the slot, D0 on the wrong pin, no 3.3 V	Watch the module's LED blink while turning the wheel
Camera not found	Webcam not detected	ls /dev/video* should list it; try another USB port or cable
No sound	No amp power, cable on the wrong pins	5 V on the PAM8403; speaker-test (step 11); tip → L, shield → G
Battery shows 0 % or nothing	Divider not on A1, or wrong resistors	Divider middle → A1; 10k on top, 4.7k to GND; ≈ 2.6 V at A1 when full
Gas value strange	Sensor still warming up, divider wrong	Wait 2-5 min; check 10k on top, 20k to GND
App cannot find the robot	Phone on another network	Same Wi-Fi or join Raqib-Robot; the robot says its address at start-up

> Logs on the Pi: `journalctl -u inspection-robot -f` (robot) and `journalctl -u raqib-server -f` (server). The app's **Robot health** screen shows every part with a hint when it is red.

8 Final checklist before a demo

- ☐ Cells charged; a spare charged pair in the bag
- ☐ Every part green in Robot health
- ☐ STOP in the app stops the robot; Reset is needed to move again
- ☐ A hand 30 cm in front of the moving robot stops it before 15 cm
- ☐ Stopping the server (sudo systemctl stop raqib-server) puts the robot in SAFE HOLD within about 10 s
- ☐ The robot starts at the Home spot, facing the same direction as when you measured the rooms
- ☐ The admin password in the app has been changed from admin123
- ☐ AI key entered in More → AI settings; "Test" says it works

9 Upgrades later

When you have more budget, add any of these. You do not change the software: at start-up the robot checks which parts answer and uses them (servos if a PCA9685 is found, the ribbon camera before the webcam, a BME680 before the AHT20, a UPS gauge before the battery divider). Press **Re-check parts** in Robot health after fitting one.

You want	Add	Extra RM
Look around without turning PCA9685 on the I²C rails, its ch0/ch1 → ENA/ENB (instead of pins 33/35), servos on ch14/ch15, webcam on the bracket.	PCA9685 + 2 SG90 servos + pan/tilt bracket	≈ 40
Sharper photos Ribbon into the CAMERA port. The robot tries the ribbon camera first, then the webcam.	Pi Camera OV5647 (≈ RM 35) or v2 (≈ RM 120) + long ribbon	35-128
Air quality (VOC) Replaces the AHT20 on the same 4 wires.	BME680 board	≈ 45
Longer run time Pi on its own battery; the motors keep the 2 × 18650 pack. Its battery gauge joins the I²C rails.	UPS module 3S + 3 more 18650 cells	≈ 175
Smoother video Same wiring.	Raspberry Pi 4, 4 GB instead of 2 GB	≈ 50

Built it? Run the final checklist, then show it off.